Extinction Archive: Umwelt Hypothesis Dossiers

When a species is already gone, what can an exhibition still offer? The project uses an interactive globe as a public entry, placing open archives, distributional evidence, causes of extinction, and ethical questions on one map—moving visitors from knowing it is absent to understanding how it disappeared.

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Design Concept

Extinction Archive is not about "resurrecting the past," nor does it turn extinction into spectacle. It is a public digital memorial: through a globe of light points, species dossiers, and checkable sources, it brings back into view lives pushed toward disappearance by hunting, trade, habitat change, invasive species, pollution, or by-catch. Each story returns from a headline to a place—where it lived, what was recorded, and how the end was reached.ached.

Why These Species

Species are not selected for curiosity, but for representativeness and a verifiable chain of evidence. The list spans landmasses, islands, and nearshore regions, and surfaces multiple drivers of loss. A few "flagship threads" make time, archival ethics, and absent soundscapes legible; the remaining points are broader samples, together showing that end points often follow long-term, compounding pressures—not a single cause.

Design Ideas

The visual language uses a dark globe, low-saturation natural tones, and archive paper hues—avoiding tech triumphalism. The hierarchy moves from the world to the individual: scale of loss first, checkable detail second.

Principle

Artificial intelligence is neither creator nor substitute for evidence. It acts as a careful cataloger—organizing materials, connecting image and sound, and surfacing relationships between sources. Generated outputs must name sources, preserve uncertainty, and never present imagination as fact.

Experience Flow

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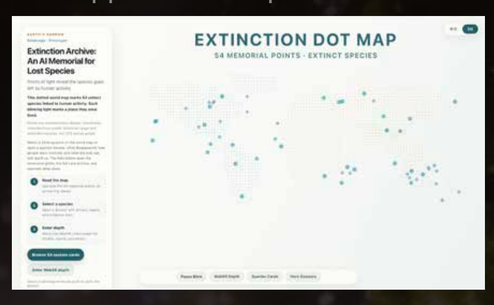
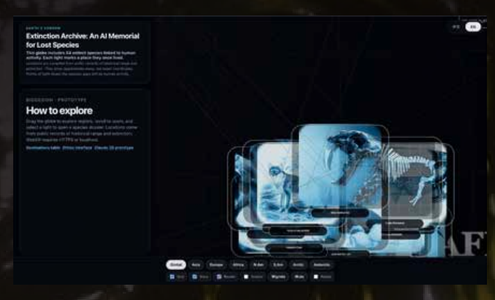
• Enter the globe

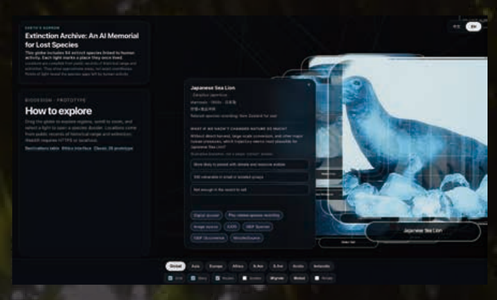
Read the world first,
then approach one species.



• Select a point

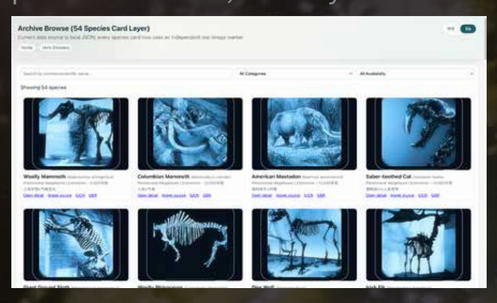
Each location opens a dossier:
region, era, cause, and cited sources.

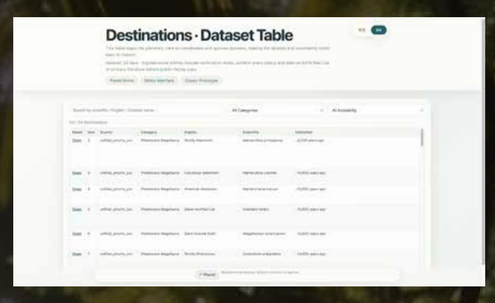




• Understand the leaving

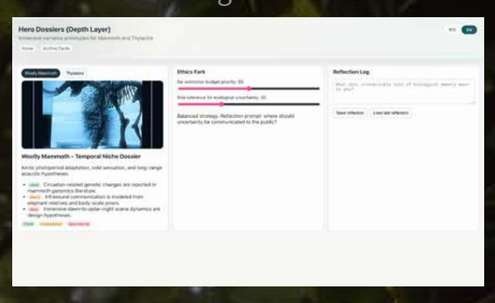
Images, sound, paths, and questions are juxtaposed to show how disappearance unfolds, not only that it did.





• Leave a reflection

Questions of responsibility,
uncertainty in the record,
and future ecological choice.



Ethics & Limits

Lost species must not be reduced to a tech spectacle. When colonial history, Indigenous knowledge, specimen collection, and de-extinction enter the frame, the narrative should state who records, who is affected, and who may interpret. Memorial practice is not possession—it is making responsibility and evidence visible together.